Now You're Cookin'

By Ira Brodsky and Barbara Lhota

AMY SUE and BONNIE: *(Singing, first one then the other, then both together.)* "Keep on bakin' until it hurts. You're getting your just-You're getting your just-You're getting your *(Big finish.)* JUST DESSERTS!"

AMY SUE: I'm Amy Sue Lewis.

BONNIE: And I'm Bonnie Badinage. And you're watching the best little cooking show on Cleveland Public Access TV

AMY SUE and BONNIE: *Just Desserts!*

BONNIE: Amy Sue and I are co-founders of Cleveland's number-one pastry cafe-

AMY SUE: At least we think it's number one

AMY SUE and BONNIE: And it's called *(Laughing.)* Just Desserts!!

BONNIE: Located just down Route 6 at the Highland Shopping Center.

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS 1: *Now You're Cookin'*
ACTRESS 2: *by Ira Brodsky and Barbara Lhota*

AMY SUE: Bonnie, we sure crack ourselves up, don't we?

BONNIE: We're funny as a meringue made with egg yolks.

AMY SUE: *(Laughing and explaining to the audience.)* As you guys know, a meringue is made with egg whites!

BONNIE: In fact, if you just get one tiny drop of yolk in it -- flat as *(Makes a raspberry sound)* -- Amy Sue. *(Amy Sue tries to laugh, but she is hurt.)* I'm just kiddin', Amy Sue. You've got nothing to be ashamed of. If you were one of the Spice girls-you remember there was Sporty Spice and Baby Spice?

AMY SUE: Sure, I remember.

BONNIE: Well, you'd be Spice Rack. Get it, Spice *(Gesturing to her chest.)* Rack?

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AMY SUE: *(Dryly.)* Yeah, yeah. On past episodes of *Just Desserts,* we've shown you how to make puff pastry and souffles and

BONNIE: Napoleons and crepes suzette-

AMY SUE: And today, it's an American classic-cupcakes with three kinds of icing.

BONNIE: That may not sound very exciting.

AMY SUE: What? I love cupcakes! They taste like childhood on a platter.

BONNIE: I don't know about that. But I do know that cupcakes were first introduced in the 1800s when poor wagon women going across the prairies didn't have enough flour to bake large birthday cakes.

AMY SUE: Wow, I didn't know that!

BONNIE: That's what I'm here for.

AMY SUE: So let's get baking. I'm going to start with a good all-purpose batter.

BONNIE: Now don't forget salt.

AMY SUE: *(Annoyed.)* And a pinch of salt.

BONNIE: Most cakes have a pinch of salt to offset the sweetness.

AMY SUE: Yes. Now, we're going to add our wet ingredients. Two eggs and a stick of melted butter. *(She cracks eggs against the side of the bowl.)*

BONNIE: For easier mixing, crack the eggs into a separate dish and whisk them up before adding to the bowl like Amy Sue just did. Avoid eggshell mishaps.

AMY SUE: *(Looks slightly put out.)* Good tip, Bonnie B.

BONNIE: Notice that I've preheated the oven to 350 degrees, and I've prepared the cake tin with a dusting of flour.

AMY SUE: Oh, I was going to use those little paper cups. See look, they come in all kinds of pretty colors and patterns.

BONNIE: When we return, I'll talk about other, better options then those messy paper cups. So stick around, and come back for your ***Just Desserts***. *(Taping stops.)*

AMY SUE: What's got into you? You're stepping on my lines, correcting my ideas-

BONNIE: We need to pick up the pace. Keep things lively.

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AMY SUE: Oh, so we're back to that.

BONNIE: I just wish you'd prepare a little better.

AMY SUE: Is that true about the wagon train?

BONNIE: All right, that just sort of came to me. We can edit that out. But you know about beating the eggs before adding them.

AMY SUE: So I forgot. Big deal. It doesn't ruin the cake. But you make me look like a- *(She reaches into her jacket pocket for her cell phone and flips it on.)* Moron! Hello? Sissy? Hi, Sissy. What's up? *(To Bonnie.)* It's Sissy from the cafe.

BONNIE: Yeah, I got that when you said "Hi, Sissy."

AMY SUE: There you go again. *(Back on phone.)* What did you say? Bill didn't show up again? *(To Bonnie.)* Bill's sick.

BONNIE: Do we have any customers?

AMY SUE: *(On phone.)* Bonnie wants to know how's business? A-huh. Yeah. A-huh. Sure. *(To Bonnie.)* Dead.

BONNIE: Did she remember to take the "Closed" sign down this time?

AMY SUE: *(In phone.)* Did you hear that? *(She looks at Bonnie.)* Oops.

BONNIE: Oh my-

AMY SUE: Wait. Sissy says someone just walked in the door. *(She covers receiver.)* Everything'll be OK.

BONNIE: With one customer?!

AMY SUE: *(To Bonnie.)* Oops, false alarm. They were looking for the taxidermist.

BONNIE: We're sunk. Give me that phone.

AMY SUE: I can handle this.

BONNIE: Give me the phone!

AMY SUE: What? Sissy called me, Bonnie!

BONNIE: *(Holding out hand.)* Phone. *(Amy Sue reluctantly hands it over. Into phone.)* OK, Sissy. Now, what are you wearing today. A-hah, good. Is it tight? Good. Now what I want you to do is take a big tray of pastries, all different kinds, and cut them into little bite-size pieces.

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Got that? Little pieces. You're going to set them out on a tray and walk out to the light by Route 6. I just got an idea. Are you wearing a bra? No, I'm sorry, I don't mean to be personal. But let me just say that sans bra is the way to go for this operation. *(Pause.)* No, not sand bra. It's French, it means "without." I'm just saying, we want to round up some business, and we can use all the help we can get. anyway, you're going to give out free samples to each and every car that stops at the light and be sure to point out where the cafe is. Say to them, now get this, "Come on over and get your Just Desserts." Then point to the bakery, and tell them our hours. Got it? Remember give them a little cheesecake with their coffee cake. I'll call you back later. Remember, customers equal tips, and happy customers equal really, really big tips. *(Bonnie clicks off)*

AMY SUE: That was disgusting and immoral.

BONNIE: It's business. It's practicality. It's saving our livelihood.

AMY SUE: No, I mean how you took the phone from me.

BONNIE: My God, chill Amy Sue. Desperate times demand desperate measures.

AMY SUE: But why is it that you're always the top dog?

BONNIE: Everybody has their place in life. I'm loud. I'm assertive. That's Bonnie!

AMY SUE: Then who am I?

BONNIE: You're the nice one. You're the sweet one. You're the pinch of sugar.

AMY SUE: I don't like that. It sounds so dull.

BONNIE: Well, you are dull. I meant that in a nice way. What I meant is that you're nice. You're pretty and sweet and you have a nice voice.

AMY SUE: And you sound like a fog horn!

BONNIE: Now that's not very nice.

AMY SUE: You're right. I'm sorry, but you got me upset.

BONNIE: Well, let's finish the taping. And we'll talk about this afterwards.

AMY SUE: OK, I guess.

BONNIE: Let's have a great show. *(Smiling.)* And give them a little cheesecake with their cupcakes. Ready? *(Counting down for the taping.)* Three, two, one.

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AMY SUE: *(Long pause while Amy Sue gives her brightest smile to the camera. She bats her eyelashes. She speaks in a new voice that is deep and sultry.)* Welcome back. I'm Amy Sue Lewis and we are too, too hot to handle.

BONNIE: *(Gives Amy Sue a horrified look.)* I'm Bonnie Badinage, and let's get baking.

AMY SUE: *(Is possessed by an aggressive sex-kitten attitude.)* We're cooking big, round, fluffy cupcakes. Bonnie, will you fill those tins for little ol' me, while I begin the frosting. *(With emphasis.)* It's a creamy cheesy frosting.

BONNIE: For God's sake, it's a cream cheese frosting. *(She mimes filling the tins.)*

AMY SUE: I have two large, very large, packages of Philadelphia cream cheese that I'm going to massage together with my bare hands.

BONNIE: We're not supposed to mention name brands, Amy Sue!

AMY SUE: Now I don't think those dear Philadelphians would mind a bit.

BONNIE: I've got the hand mixer here, and I'm going to add sugar and a touch of vanilla to the cream cheese. *(Amy Sue provides the sound effects.)* Now over here, I have a tray of cupcakes that we already baked and cooled.

AMY SUE: *(Rubbing the tops of the cupcakes.)* Bouncy, bouncy cupcakes.

BONNIE: *(Slaps Amy Sue's hand away.)* Stop it!

AMY SUE: *(Playing it up, kissing her hand.)* Ouchy! You're so rough, Bonnie baby!

BONNIE: *(Getting down to business.)* I have my offset spatula, a very handy tool, and I'm ready to ice. Take a nice big dollop of icing, and start working it around from the center in concentric circles. *(There is something sensual in this activity, and Amy Sue sees it.)*

AMY SUE: Swirly, swirly ... I bet those cupcakes are lovin' that action.

BONNIE: Amy Sue!

AMY SUE: Well, what's wrong? A little cheesecake with your cupcakes, remember?

BONNIE: We're professional bakers.

AMY SUE: And come on down to our cafe on Route 6 where Sissy the waitress will make you feel very, very good. She may even let you lick her beater.

BONNIE: Enough! Down girl! Zip it!

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AMY SUE: Let's get to decorating, which is something I love.

BONNIE: Good. Notice that we have a whole range of colored sugars and draggees.

AMY SUE: *(Giggling.)* Draggees? What's that?

BONNIE: These little silver balls.

AMY SUE: Oh, I love the silver balls! Look how smooth and shiny.

BONNIE: So start decorating! Just shut up, please, and get to work. *(To audience.)* While Amy Sue and I are decorating up a storm, we're going to take a brief commercial.

AMY SUE: And you guys might want to rush on over to Just Desserts on Route 6 where you can sink your teeth into one of our yummy cupcakes, served by the equally yummy Sissy the waitress. Yum, yum. We'll be waitin' on ya. *(She winks.) (Taping stops.)*

BONNIE: "Yum, yum. Winky, winky"? What are you thinking, Amy Sue?!

AMY SUE: Nice, nice! I'll show you nice! I'm getting in touch with my inner tigress-roar!

BONNIE: You're going to get us in touch with the TV censors. We're going to lose our show as well as our bakery!

AMY SUE: Well, I don't care! I'm sick of nice.

BONNIE: You don't care?! Remember that loan we took for $25,000? Well, that's in both our names, tiger. And didn't you put up your house as collateral?

AMY SUE: *(Sheepish.)* Ugh.

BONNIE: "Ugh" is right, cupcake.

AMY SUE: I'm sorry, Bonnie.

BONNIE: What good is sorry now?

AMY SUE: I don't know. I guess not much.

BONNIE: No, it isn't.

AMY SUE: I'll fix things up.

BONNIE: I don't see how.

AMY SUE: By going back to being "nice"?

BONNIE: I don't know if you can. People out there are wondering, "Who is Amy Sue?" You've lost their trust.

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AMY SUE: In five minutes?

BONNIE: You've lost my trust.

AMY SUE: I'm sorry, Bonnie. I'm a big doody head!

BONNIE: Let's just finish the show, and I'll clean up this mess afterwards-as usual.

AMY SUE: OK, Bonnie.

BONNIE: *(Counting down to restart taping.)* Three, two, one. Welcome back to ***Just Desserts***. I'm still Bonnie Badinage.

AMY SUE: *(Monotone and dead-eyed.)* And I'm Amy Sue Lewis.

BONNIE: We're here finishing up our cupcakes and making them ready for presentation.

AMY SUE: *(Robotic.)* Yes. Nice presentation.

BONNIE: *(Holding up a tray.)* You can see we have a whole bunch of decorating ideas to really spruce up your cakes. They're a great way to show off your individuality.

AMY SUE: But you don't want too much individuality or you might scare people off. The orange pumpkin is very interesting. Nice for Halloween.

BONNIE: *(Ignoring Amy Sue.)* We have a flag motif with red- white-and-blue stars.

AMY SUE: Nice for July 4th. Again, not too extreme.

BONNIE: *(To Amy Sue.)* What's that sound?

AMY SUE: Huh?

BONNIE: What's that sound? Is that your cell phone?

AMY SUE: Oh, goodness, I forgot to turn it off. I'm sorry, Bonnie. *(She takes out her phone and {lips it on.}* Hi, this is Amy Sue. Oh hi, Sissy! *(To Bonnie.)* It's Sissy. *(To the audience.)* She's the waitress at Just Desserts. *(Back to Sissy.)* You're watching us on the TV at the bakery?

BONNIE: *(Trying to cut things short.)* That's great that everything is so busy at the cafe, but maybe you better talk to Sissy after the show.

AMY SUE: But it was dead a few minutes ago.

BONNIE: *(To audience.)* Oh, that Amy Sue! What a kidder! But a really nice kidder! Now let me show you how to make this multi-tier snowman cupcake for a winter treat.

AMY SUE: *(To Sissy.)* You've got a whole crowd at the cafe? *(To Bonnie.)* You were right. Things

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are hoppin'! *(To Sissy.)* So what's up? Yeah? A-huh. Ohhh! Really? Let me ask Bonnie. *(To Bonnie.)* Guess what? Everybody at the shop loved the last segment. They want to know what happened to me, and how to get it back.

BONNIE: What?!

AMY SUE: They thought I was really funny. *(Back to Sissy.)* And what? *(To Bonnie.)* And spicy.

BONNIE: Spicy? No, that's not right. I'm the salt and vinegar. You're the pinch of sugar.

AMY SUE: Not according to the folks at the bakery. *(Trying out the sex kitten persona again.)* Apparently double spice can be twice as nice.

BONNIE: Wait a second! Let me talk to Sissy.

AMY SUE: *(Getting her "spicy" persona into gear. To Bonnie.)* Now hold on, sugar. *(Back to Sissy.)* Not you, sugar. The other sugar. Well, you tell everyone at Just Desserts to eat on up, and we'll stop by after the show.

BONNIE: I want to talk to Sissy!

AMY SUE: *(Snapping the phone off)* Sorry, Bonnie. We have a show to finish up. And I don't want to waste time yapping on the phone when I can be cookin' with you and the folks at home. **In** fact, we're cooking with gasoline. **In** fact, we're two hot chili peppers.

BONNIE: In fact, judging by the way our producer is waving his arms, we're out of time.

AMY SUE: Rrrrr, Bonnie.

BONNIE: *(Trying to get into the spirit.)* Rrrr! Right back at you. *(Holding up the tray.)* Oh look, we have a little tiger stripe cupcake. Isn't that cute?

AMY SUE: Cute. Cute? It's fierce, I'd say.

BONNIE: Just like you, Amy Sue Lewis.

AMY SUE: And just like you too, Bonnie Badinage. So for both of us, I'd like to say, keep baking until you get your

AMY SUE and BONNIE: Just Desserts!

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